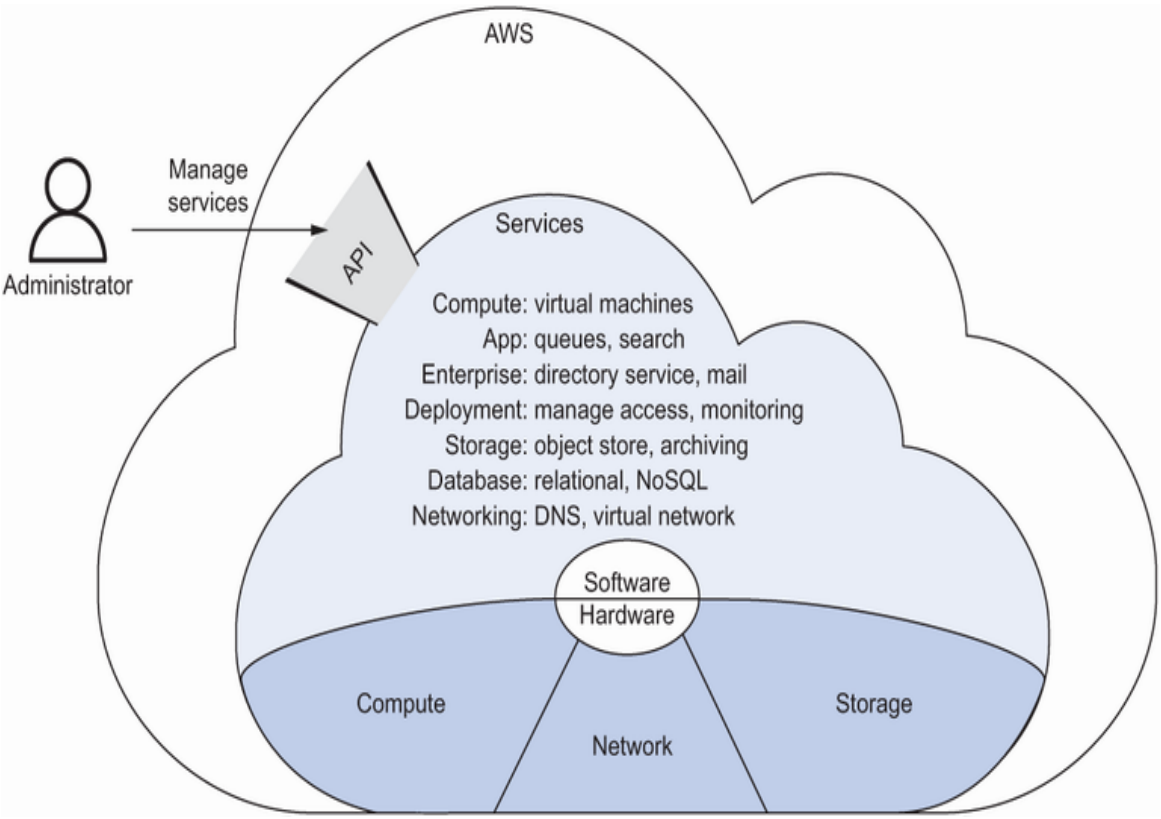


Figure 4.1 The AWS cloud is composed of hardware and software services accessible via an API.

Let's look at how the API works. Imagine you uploaded a few files to the object store S3 (you will learn about S3 in chapter 7). Now you want to list all the files in the S3 object store to check whether the upload was successful. Using the raw HTTP API, you send a `GET` request to the API endpoint using the following HTTP protocol:

```
GET / HTTP/1.1                          ①
Host: BucketName.s3.amazonaws.com       ②
Authorization: [...]                    ③
```

① HTTP method GET, HTTP resource /, using HTTP protocol version 1.1

② Specifies the host name; keep in mind that TCP/IP knows only about IP addresses and ports.

③ Authentication information (details omitted)

The HTTP response will look like this: